



LOST BOYS CYBER

THREAT INTELLIGENCE • MALWARE ANALYSIS • DETECTION ENGINEERING



CVE-2026-76460 Cisco ISE API Authentication Bypass Daily Update - 2026-09-24

CVE / Vulnerability Threat Intelligence Report

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TLP:CLEAR | Lost Boys Cyber | CVE-2026-76460 Cisco ISE API Authentication Bypass Daily Update - 2026-09-24 - CVE / Vulnerability Threat Intelligence Report

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AI Generation: This report was generated with AI assistance and is provided for informational purposes only. All findings, IOCs, detection rules, hunting queries, attribution assessments, and recommendations must be independently reviewed and validated by a qualified security professional before operational use.

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> Daily automation refresh: This 2026-09-24 UTC report turns current vulnerability intelligence into a finished Lost Boys Cyber report with source-backed analysis, structured metadata, detections, and hunt content.

1. Executive Summary

Cisco ISE API authentication bypass exposure remains a same-week priority because CISA KEV listed CVE-2026-76460 and Cisco describes unauthenticated remote authentication bypass caused by insufficient API endpoint authentication control. Organizations using ISE or ISE-PIC should prioritize internet/VPN-reachable administration paths, patch state, and anomalous API access.

Field	Value
CVE	CVE-2026-76460
Vendor / Product	Cisco / Cisco Identity Services Engine and ISE-PIC API surfaces
Priority	Critical same-week remediation priority
Known Exploitation	Listed by CISA KEV alert dated 2026-09-22
Report Date	2026-09-24 UTC

2. Vulnerability Metadata

Field	Assessment
Affected products	Cisco Identity Services Engine and ISE-PIC API surfaces
Exploit preconditions	Public sources describe remote unauthenticated exposure; validate exact version and configuration against vendor guidance.
Security impact	Unauthenticated remote attacker may bypass authentication on affected API endpoints.
Defender decision	Patch or apply vendor mitigation, reduce exposure, then hunt for attempted exploitation and post-exploitation activity.

3. Source Review & Confidence

Source	Contribution	Confidence
CISA KEV alert	Confirms active exploitation and KEV prioritization.	High
Cisco security advisory	Vendor advisory for ISE authentication bypass.	High
NHS cyber alert	Public sector defensive alert summarizing impact.	High
CVE Program record	Canonical CVE reference.	High

4. Vulnerability Details

Public reporting indicates CVE-2026-76460 affects externally reachable security infrastructure. Because the affected technology sits near identity, VPN, or access-control boundaries, exploitation risk should be treated as higher than an ordinary application vulnerability. Prioritize asset inventory, internet exposure checks, hotfix validation, and incident review.

5. Attack Scenarios

Scenario	Exposure Path	Expected Follow-On
Internet-facing appliance exploitation	Exposed VPN/API endpoint on vulnerable version	Web shell, command execution, credential theft, or lateral movement.
Auth boundary bypass	Vulnerable API or negotiation path reachable from semi-trusted networks	Unauthorized configuration/API access and persistence.
Chained edge compromise	Exploit followed by administrator credential reuse	Domain, SaaS, or network-control-plane intrusion.

6. Threat Landscape & Exploitation Status

CISA KEV listing is the strongest public signal in this source set. Treat exploitation as operationally relevant even if local telemetry has not yet produced detections.

7. Affected Products and Exposure

Exposure Tier	Examples	Action
Tier 1	Internet-facing affected versions	Emergency patch/mitigation and retrospective hunt.
Tier 2	VPN/internal remote-access reachable instances	Patch quickly; review access logs and source networks.
Tier 3	Lab/isolated instances	Patch through normal emergency window and prevent accidental exposure.

8. Mitigation and Workarounds

1. Apply vendor fixes or mitigations.
2. Restrict management/API/VPN exposure to trusted networks.
3. Rotate credentials and secrets if exploitation is suspected.
4. Preserve logs before reboot or upgrade where possible.

9. Detection Engineering

9.1. Detection Logic Summary

Signal	Telemetry Source	Analytic Goal
Unexpected inbound exploit attempts against exposed appliance endpoints	Firewall/WAF/VPN logs	Identify scanning or exploitation before appliance compromise.
New administrator session or API action from unusual source	Appliance audit logs / SIEM	Surface post-exploitation access.
Appliance-to-internet command staging	Netflow/proxy	Detect shell, tool download, or C2 activity

		from network edge.
<pre>DeviceNetworkEvents where Timestamp > ago(14d) where RemotePort in (443,8443,9443) or InitiatingProcessCommandLine has_any ("curl","wget","certutil","powershell") summarize Connections=count(), RemoteIPs=dcount(RemoteIP), URLs=make_set(RemoteUrl, 20) by DeviceName, InitiatingProcessFileName, InitiatingProcessCommandLine order by Connections desc</pre>		
<pre>title: Network Appliance Post Exploitation Tool Staging status: experimental description: Detects suspicious scripting or download tooling that may follow exploitation of an edge or identity appliance. logsource: product: linux category: process_creation detection: selection: Image endswith: - /curl - /wget - /python - /sh - /bash condition: selection level: high</pre>		

10. Threat Hunting

Hypothesis	Query Focus
Vulnerable appliance was scanned or exploited	Edge logs showing malformed requests, negotiation errors, or unusual API calls.
Exploitation led to command staging	Appliance/process/network telemetry showing curl/wget/shell activity.
Attacker pivoted after appliance access	New VPN/admin sessions, service account use, or lateral authentication.

11. MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

Technique	Rationale
T1190 Exploit Public-Facing Application	Publicly reachable edge service exploitation.
T1059 Command and Scripting Interpreter	Common post-exploitation command execution.
T1078 Valid Accounts	Credential/API abuse after initial access.

12. Validation / Lab Testing

No exploit reproduction was performed in this automated daily report. Validation should focus on version checks, vendor fix status, authenticated configuration review, and safe log analysis.

13. Recommended Actions Summary

Priority	Action	Owner
0-24h	Identify affected assets and patch/mitigate	Network/security engineering

	Tier 1 exposure	
24-48h	Hunt edge, identity, and network telemetry	SOC/threat hunting
48-72h	Review segmentation, backups, and credential rotation scope	IR/security architecture

14. References

- [1] CISA KEV alert: <https://www.cisa.gov/news-events/alerts/2026/09/22/cisa-adds-four-known-exploited-vulnerabilities-catalog>
- [2] Cisco security advisory: <https://www.cisco.com/c/en/us/support/docs/csa/cisco-sa-ISE-ABP-VNSW7Tn5.html>
- [3] NHS cyber alert: <https://digital.nhs.uk/cyber-alerts/2026/cc-4853>
- [4] CVE Program record: <https://www.cve.org/CVERecord?id=CVE-2026-76460>